Group 1

Digitizing WA's Unemployment Site

Project Members

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Think and feel?

- Worry whether answered questions correctly
- time consuming
- frustrated with unemployment site
- long wait to receive the payment
- I wish there was a live chat option
- I wish there was a Japanese translation
- lengthy questions
- impatient
- frustrated
- uncertainty
- Rent is due
- anxious

Hear?

- check if you're eligible when you're furloughed
- "You might be eligible"
- you'll hear back eventually
- "Just fill out the form"
- "we need more information"
- daughter needs things

See?

- cluttered site
- looking up the definition of a word doesnt help
- page to check eligibility
- only spanish translation available
- other employees getting payments
- website crashing

Say and do?

- "I don't understand"
- Try to find other work
- Weekly claims
- confusing and ambiguous questions
- ask native english speakers for help
- "don't they already have this information?"
- Call unemployment office for help

Pain

- no income
- need to pay for kids
- Difficulty to buy daily needs
- difficulty accessing the unemployment eligibility checker
- Uncertainty- when will this be over?

Gain

- No more work - more ability to relax
- more time with family
- unemployment payments

User 1: Jess

Step 1: Gets call that she is getting furloughed

Step 2: Visit esd.wa.gov to read about unemployment

Step 3: Create profile

Step 4: Open eligibility checker app

Step 5: Answer questions 1 by 1: they update in real time

Step 5 (cont:) When confused - use live chatbot

Step 6: end questionnaire and given "quote" (likely outcome/ Amount $)

Step 7: gets confirmation and can check back the status in her account

Step 8: Decide whether to subscribe to notifications (application status, policy updates, etc.)

User 2: Heather

Step1: Was fired from her part time job

Step2: Visited the website to find out she is ineligible for the regular unemployment benefits

Step3: Found out she is eligible for the COVID19 pandemic unemployment benefits

Step 4: fill out application, use chat to ask questions

Step 5: submit application, told when to expect payment

Before Applying

- unsure if eligible
- Didn't know eligibility checker existed
- Worried if she worked enough hours to be eligible
- Worried about no income
- Main source of information from coworkers
- unsure where to check eligibility
- cluttered website
- Overwhelemd

While Applying

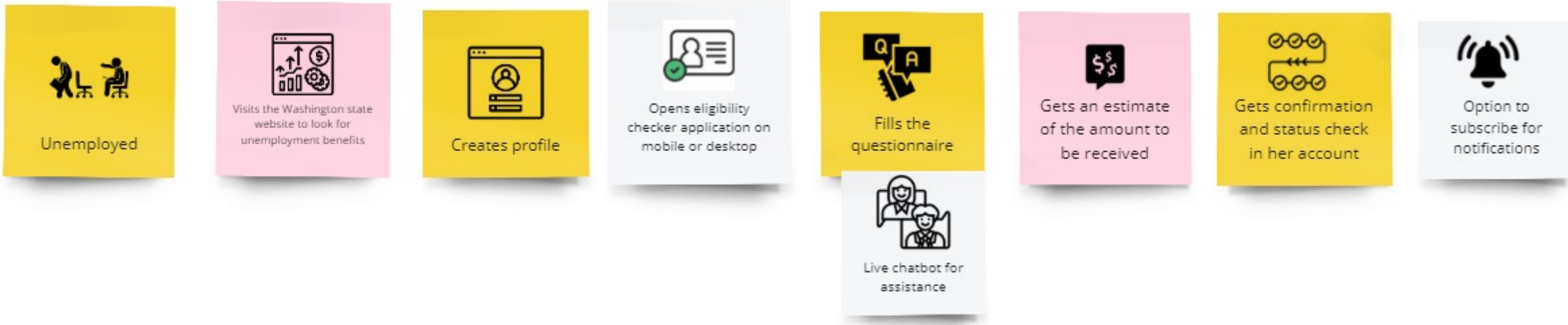
- Unclear/ambiguous vocabulary
- Embedded questions with different answers to each
- Not accessible in other languages
- Trying to interpret how to best answer questions to make the process easier/get payments quicker
- No live support
  - asking native english speakers for help
- taking a long time to apply (2 hours)
- phone line wont pick up
  - Had to call 163 times to get through
- can't exit out & return
- Website keeps crashing

After Applying

- Unclear when results would be coming
- Answered question wrong causing to take even logner
- Takes too long to find out results
- Impatient
- seems intentionally confusing
- Questions' language intentionally discouraging
- Froze the application, asking to return the money she received
- Try to decide how else to get income in meantime
- Even after using eligibility checker, still unsure whether eligible
- inaccessible to part time/ non traditional workers

Brainstorming

- Questions appear one at a time (less overwhelming)
- Clear feedback
- translations other than spanish
- 24/7 chat support
- Language translation
- Estimated time to completion
  - able to save & return to application
- simple eligibility check
- Faster turn around time for applications
- FAQ for confusing questions
- Screen reader to make it accessible
  - Make the form interactive instead of PDF


Unemployed
Visits the Washington state website to look for unemployment benefits
Creates profile
Opens eligibility checker application on mobile or desktop
Fills the questionnaire
Live chatbot for assistance
Gets an estimate of the amount to be received
Gets confirmation and status check in her account
Option to subscribe for notifications

Unresponsiveness

- phone line wont pick up
- Website keeps crashing
- Had to call 163 times to get through
- No live support

Emotional Distress

- Overwhelemd
- Worried about no income
- Try to decide how else to get income in meantime
- Impatient
- Questions' language intentionally discouraging

Uncertainty

- unsure if eligible
- Worried if she worked enough hours to be eligible
- seems intentionally confusing
- unsure where to check eligibility
- Unclear/ambiguous vocabulary
- Even after using eligibility checker, still unsure whether eligible
- Embedded questions with different answers to each
- Unclear when results would be coming
- Trying to interpret how to best answer questions to make the process easier/get payments quicker

Website issues/ accessibility

- Didn't know eligibility checker existed
- unsure where to check eligibility
- cluttered website
- asking native english speakers for help
- Not accessible in other languages
- Website keeps crashing
- inaccessible to part time/ non traditional workers
- can't exit out & return
- Froze the application, asking to return the money she received

Time

- taking a long time to apply (2 hours)
- Impatient
- Takes too long to find out results
- Answered question wrong causing to take even logner

Results

Users prefer "progress bar" prototype

Question order and wording is still the most confusing part

Wording is better, but more clarification needed

Users like the chatbot function

Some questions are repeated in the actual application

Ideas

The aspect of the checklist where they can see how many questions/ change answers is desired

Simplify/use yes or no questions instead of calculations

Color palette that isnt too overbearing

What we need next

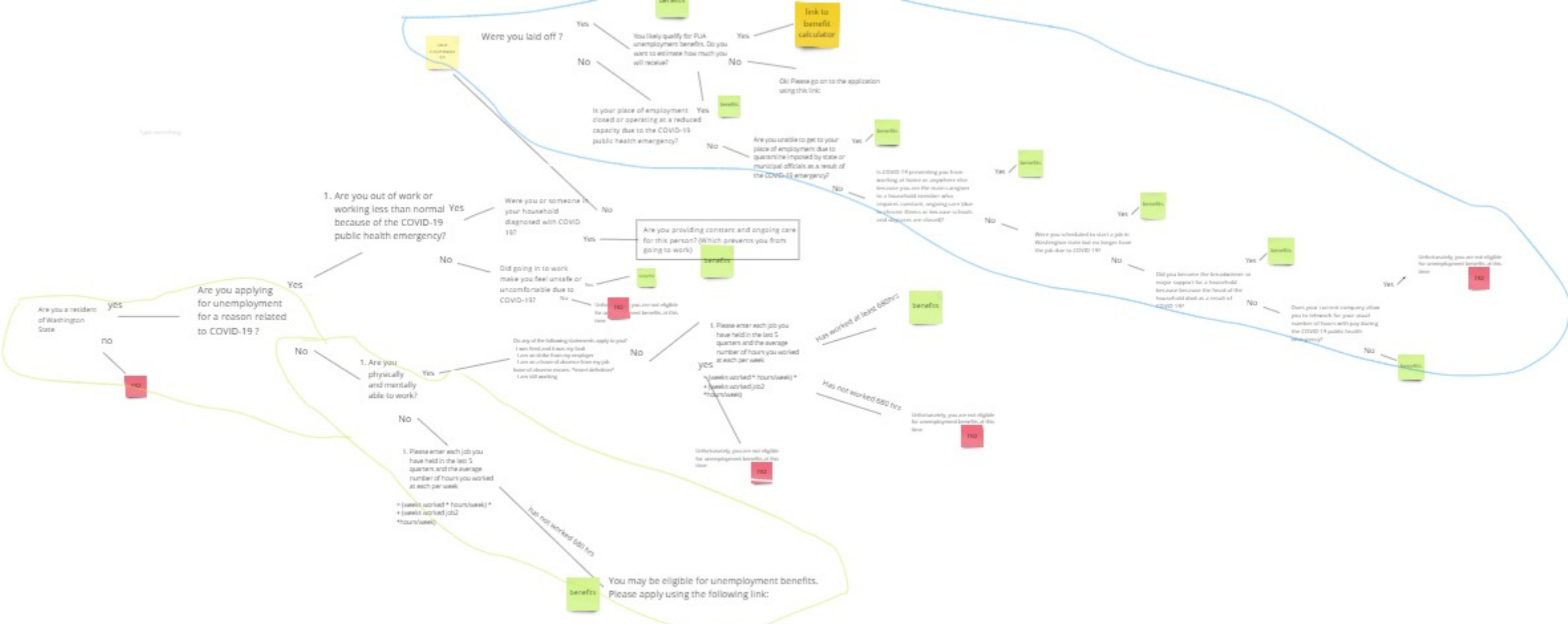
"back" button

Progress bar

Automate 680 hours question using input

Chatbot on each questions or FAQ

Have a point to quit if they just want to determine eligibility and not amount $


Were you laid off ?
Yes
No
You likely qualify for PUA unemployment benefits. Do you want to estimate how much you will receive?
Yes
link to benefit calculator
No
Ok! Please go on to the application using this link:
benefits
benefits
Is your place of employment closed or operating at a reduced capacity due to the COVID-19 public health emergency?
Yes
benefits
No
Are you unable to get to your place of employment due to quarantine imposed by state or municipal officials as a result of the COVID-19 emergency?
Yes
benefits
No
Is COVID-19 preventing you from working at home or anywhere else because you are the main caregiver to a household member who requires constant, ongoing care (due to illness, illness or because schools and daycares are closed)?
Yes
benefits
No
Were you scheduled to start a job in Washington state but no longer have the job due to COVID-19?
Yes
benefits
No
Did you become the breadwinner or major support for a household because because the head of the household died as a result of COVID-19?
Yes
benefits
No
Does your current company allow you to telework for your usual number of hours with pay during the COVID-19 public health emergency?
Yes
Unfortunately, you are not eligible for unemployment benefits, at this time
no
No
benefits
1. Are you out of work or working less than normal because of the COVID-19 public health emergency?
Yes
Were you or someone in your household diagnosed with COVID 19?
No
Yes
Are you providing constant and ongoing care for this person? (Which prevents you from going to work)
benefits
No
Did going in to work make you feel unsafe or uncomfortable due to COVID-19?
Yes
benefits
No
Unfortunately, you are not eligible for unemployment benefits, at this time
no
Are you a resident of Washington State
yes
no
no
Are you applying for unemployment for a reason related to COVID-19 ?
Yes
No
1. Are you physically and mentally able to work?
Yes
Do any of the following statements apply to you?
- I was fired and it was my fault
- I am satisfied having employer
- I am on a leave of absence from my job
- Some of absence reasons. *Insert definition*
- I am still working
No
1. Please enter each job you have held in the last 5 quarters and the average number of hours you worked as each per week
= (weeks worked * hours/week) * + (weeks worked job2 *hours/week)
Has worked at least 680hrs
benefits
yes
Has not worked 680 hrs
Unfortunately, you are not eligible for unemployment benefits, at this time
no
Unfortunately, you are not eligible for unemployment benefits, at this time
no
No
1. Please enter each job you have held in the last 5 quarters and the average number of hours you worked as each per week
= (weeks worked * hours/week) * + (weeks worked job2 *hours/week)
Has not worked 680 hrs
benefits
You may be eligible for unemployment benefits. Please apply using the following link: